Architecture and Build Report

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Site Details

My live portfolio homepage is at https://helgagaona.github.io/wdd331-portfolio/ and the source code is at https://github.com/helgagaona/wdd331-portfolio.

I chose **PostCSS** as my build tool for this assignment.

Reflection

Write a thoughtful response to each prompt. These are not summaries of what you did. They ask you to reason about why your architecture works the way it does and what would happen if it changed.

Layer Order

Layer order: @layer tokens, base, layout, components, utilities;

If I flip base with components one of the things that would change is <a> elements:

The biggest change is that <a> elements would lose their component styling and fall back to base styles instead.

In the components layer, I set:

a {

font-weight: color: var(--text-color-dark-background); # light color close to white

text-decoration: none;

}

In the base layer, I set:

a {
color: var(--color-primary); # dark pink color
text-decoration-thickness: var(--text-decoration-thickness);
}

Since the later layer wins, swapping the order means base now overrides components — every link turns my primary brand color, including the navigation menu. That makes the nav indistinguishable from surrounding text and unreadable on the navigation background color.

Token Tracing

Token: --color-primary: #c50c63

Files that consume it:

- base/elements.css
- components/buttons.css
- components/cards.css
- components/nav.css

A teammate must understand that this is a global token and not a local one, which means that it lives in specific files and it's imported by main.css at the top of the layer stack. The token controls the visual identity on the site appearing on certain elements which makes it easier to change if necessary instead of checking every file that uses it, you just adjust the token.

If writing more CSS and not using the token and hard coding instead, the site will end up with two primary colors that no longer match which can lead to unintended side effects as poorly choosing replacement colors, etc.

Placement Decisions

I was unsure to place, in fact the <a> element because links look different depending on where they are (navigation or as links on cards). I split and put the generic link style on base/elements.css because that is the style for any link on the site, and the component-specific <a> element that goes on the navigation component in components/nav.css using css nesting. This is because base will set the default look and components will override only where needed.

If I found myself writing very specific selectors in components just to be fighting with the base styles, I'd know I did something wrong and that I have to move the generic link styles out of base and place them into a more neutral reset layer to keep the minimal base styles letting each component define it's own look.